

TryHackMe's Windows Threat Detection 3 Write-Up

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This guide maps to the TryHackMe Windows Threat Detection 3 room, version present on 10/7/2026. It can be found here:

<https://tryhackme.com/room/windowsthreatdetection3>

In the following spreadsheet, I have mapped the MITRE ATT&CK Framework for the room:

https://github.com/gammagecko/TryHackMe-Windows-Threat-Detection-3-Write-Up/blob/main/Windows_Threat_Detection_3_ATTACK_Mapping.xlsx

And following is a guided walk-through for the questions:

Task 2 Question 1:

Which suspicious archive did the user download?

Event ID	Task Category
11	File created (rule)
15	File stream creat
11	File created (rule)
11	File created (rule)

We are looking for a file created event, under Event ID#11.

```
File created:
RuleName: Downloads
UtcTime: 2025-07-02 20:14:07.588
ProcessGuid: {c5d2b969-8961-6865-7d00-000000001b01}
ProcessId: 3604
Image: C:\Windows\Explorer.EXE
TargetFilename: C:\Users\Administrator\Downloads\URGENT!
CreationUtcTime: 2025-07-02 20:14:07.588
User: THM-DFIR-VM-3\Administrator
```

One of the logs at 7/2/2025 8:14:07 PM shows the answer under TargetFilename:
URGENT!.zip

Task 2 Question 2:

Where did the attackers hide the C2 malware file?

We are looking for another file creation (Event ID 11) where the attackers created and hid the file, which occurred after the first file creation. This means it will be higher up in the logs. We select the log at 7/2/2025 8:14:13 PM.

Event 11, Sysmon

General Details

```
File created:
RuleName: EXE
UtcTime: 2025-07-02 20:14:13.444
ProcessGuid: {c5d2b969-9314-6865-d500-000000001b01}
ProcessId: 3140
Image: C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe
TargetFilename: C:\Users\Administrator\AppData\Roaming\update.exe
CreationUtcTime: 2025-07-02 20:14:13.444
User: THM-DFIR-VM-3\Administrator
```

Under TargetFilename, we find our answer:

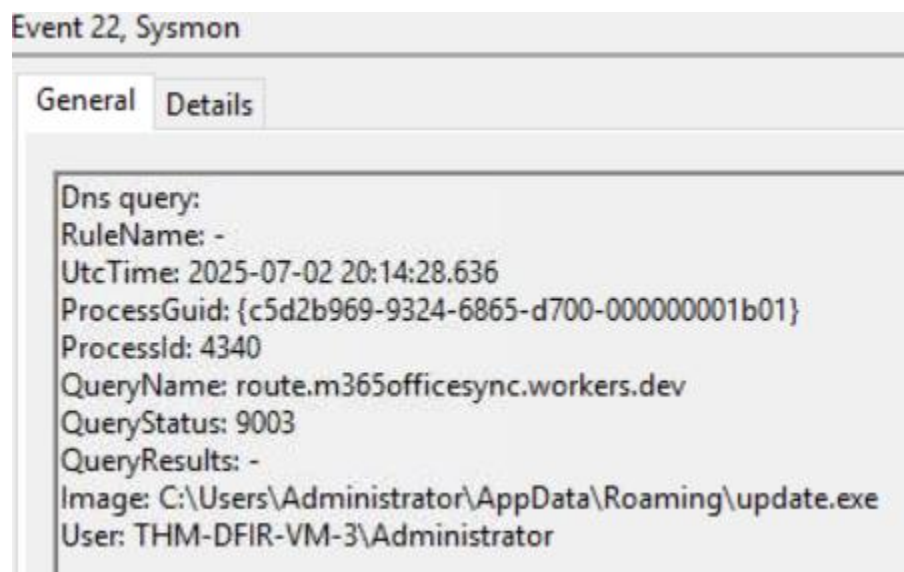
C:\Users\Administrator\AppData\Roaming\update.exe

Task 2 Question 3:

What is the domain of the Command and Control server?

Event ID	Task Category
22	Dns query (rule: DnsQuery)
1	Process Create (rule: Proc...
3	Network connection dete...
11	File created (rule: FileCrea...
11	File created (rule: FileCrea...

Now we are looking for a domain, which means a DNS query (Event ID 22). We find the log of interest on 7/2/2025 8:14:30 PM.

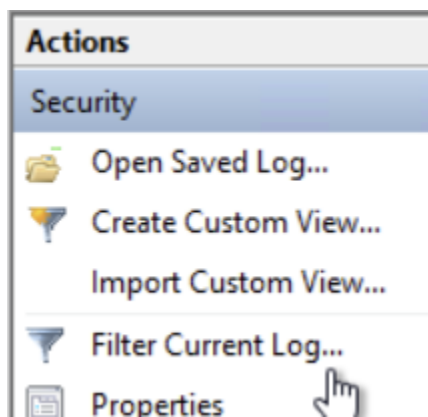


Under QueryName we find our answer: **route.m365officesync.workers.dev**.

Task 3 Question 1

How many times did the threat actor fail to log in to the Administrator?

First we need to find out the EventID for failed logins, a search will result in 4625.



On the far right, we need to then filter our current log to EventID 4625. Start by selecting “Filter Current Log”

Filter Current Log



Filter XML

Logged: Any time

Event level: ☐ Critical ☐ Warning ☐ Verbose
☐ Error ☐ Information

☒ By log Event logs: file://C:\Users\Administrator\Desktop\Practice

☐ By source Event sources:

Includes/Excludes Event IDs: Enter ID numbers and/or ID ranges separated by commas. To exclude criteria, type a minus sign first. For example 1,3,5-99,-76

4625

Task category:

Keywords:

User: <All Users>

Computer(s): <All Computers>

Clear

OK Cancel

Where it leaves a space to enter EventIDs, put it 4625 and select "OK".

Security Number of events: 31				
Filtered: Log: file://C:\Users\Administrator\Desktop\Practice\Task 3\Security.evbx; Source: ; Event ID: 4625. Number of events: 6				
Level	Date and Time	Source	Event ID	Task Category
Information	7/2/2025 9:00:20 PM	Microsoft Windows secur...	4625	Logon
Information	7/2/2025 8:58:22 PM	Microsoft Windows secur...	4625	Logon
Information	7/2/2025 8:58:18 PM	Microsoft Windows secur...	4625	Logon
Information	7/2/2025 8:58:13 PM	Microsoft Windows secur...	4625	Logon
Information	7/2/2025 8:58:09 PM	Microsoft Windows secur...	4625	Logon
Information	7/2/2025 8:58:05 PM	Microsoft Windows secur...	4625	Logon

Six logs populate. We then need to identify how many of these failed logins fall under the account “Administrator.”

Event 4625, Microsoft Windows security auditing.

General Details

An account failed to log on.

Subject:

Security ID:	NULL SID
Account Name:	-
Account Domain:	-
Logon ID:	0x0

Logon Type: 3

Account For Which Logon Failed:

Security ID:	NULL SID
Account Name:	Administrator
Account Domain:	DESKTOP-4KC4MRT

You can find the failed login account name under the field “Account Name.” All 6 of the log events fall under the “Administrator” account.

Task 3 Question 2:

After the successful login, which backdoor user did the attacker create?

As shown in the assignment text, the account creation EventID is 4720. We change our filter accordingly.

Filter Current Log

Filter XML

Logged: Any time

Event level: ☐ Critical ☐ Warning ☐ Verbose ☐ Error ☐ Information

☒ By log Event logs: file:///C:/Users/Administrator/Desktop/Practice

☐ By source Event sources:

Includes/Excludes Event IDs: Enter ID numbers and/or ID ranges separated by commas. To exclude criteria, type a minus sign first. For example 1,3,5-99,-76

4720

Task category:

Keywords:

User: <All Users>

Computer(s): <All Computers>

Clear

OK Cancel

Security Number of events: 31			
Filtered: Log: file:///C:/Users/Administrator/Desktop/Practice/Task 3/Security.evtx; Source: ; Event ID: 4720. Number of events: 1			
Level	Date and Time	Source	Event ID
Information	7/2/2025 9:01:38 PM	Microsoft Windows secur...	4720

Only one log event populates.



Under “Account Name”, we find the answer to the question – **support**.

Task 3 Question 3

Which privileged group was the backdoor user added to?

Security 4732: A member was added to a security group

From the assignment text we find the EventID.

Filter Current Log

Filter XML

Logged: Any time

Event level: ☐ Critical ☐ Warning ☐ Verbose
☐ Error ☐ Information

☒ By log Event logs: file://C:\Users\Administrator\Desktop\Practice

☐ By source Event sources:

Includes/Excludes Event IDs: Enter ID numbers and/or ID ranges separated by commas. To exclude criteria, type a minus sign first. For example 1,3,5-99,-76

4732

Task category:

Keywords:

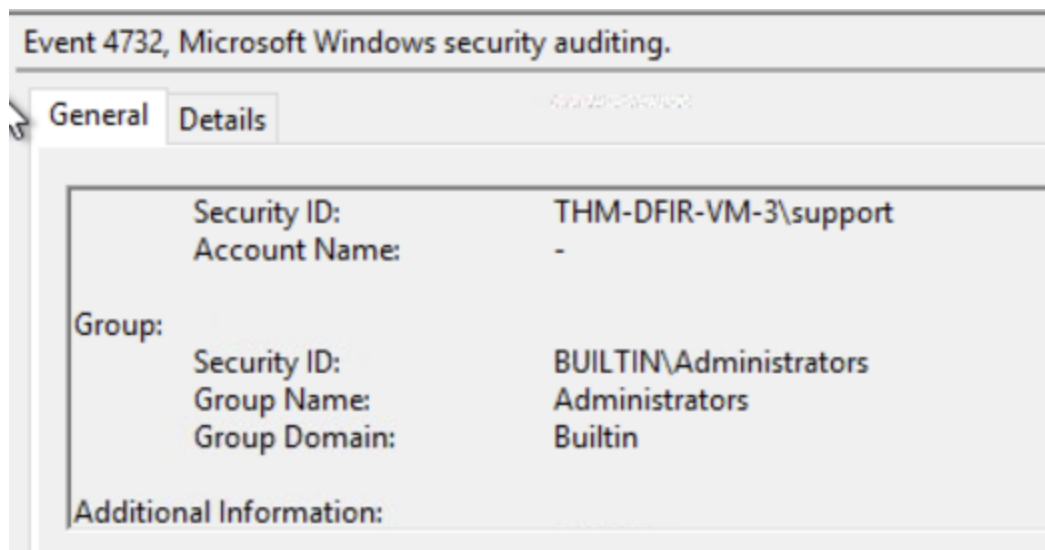
User: <All Users>

Computer(s): <All Computers>

Clear

OK Cancel

There are two log files generated. We match the username to a privileged usergroup "Administrators" in the 7/2/2025 9:02:29 PM event.



The answer is “**Administrators**”.

Task 4 Question 1:

Which Windows service was created to persist the Nessie malware?

Filter Current Log

Filter XML

Logged: Any time

Event level: ☐ Critical ☐ Warning ☐ Verbose
☐ Error ☐ Information

☒ By log Event logs: file:///C:/Users/Administrator/Desktop/Practice

☐ By source Event sources:

Includes/Excludes Event IDs: Enter ID numbers and/or ID ranges separated by commas. To exclude criteria, type a minus sign first. For example 1,3,5-99,-76

4697

Task category:

Keywords:

User: <All Users>

Computer(s): <All Computers>

Clear

OK Cancel

After tinkering around in the Sysmon logs, I went to the Security logs instead. I filtered down to eventIDs 4697 according to the assignment text:

2. Detect service creation via Security event ID 4697



At this timestamp, I found the correct event:



We find the nessie.exe file name using the Windows service “Data Protection Service” to persist.

Task 4 Question 2:

Which scheduled task was created to persist the Troy malware?

We are looking for a task, not a service, which means we select for EventID 4698 in the same Security log file.

Filter Current Log



Filter

XML

Logged:

Any time

Event level:

☐

Critical

☐

Warning

☐

Verbose

☐

Error

☐

Information

☒ By log

Event logs:

file:///C:/Users/Administrator/Desktop/Practice

☐ By source

Event sources:

Includes/Excludes Event IDs: Enter ID numbers and/or ID ranges separated by commas. To exclude criteria, type a minus sign first. For example 1,3,5-99,-76

4698

Task category:

Keywords:

User:

<All Users>

Computer(s):

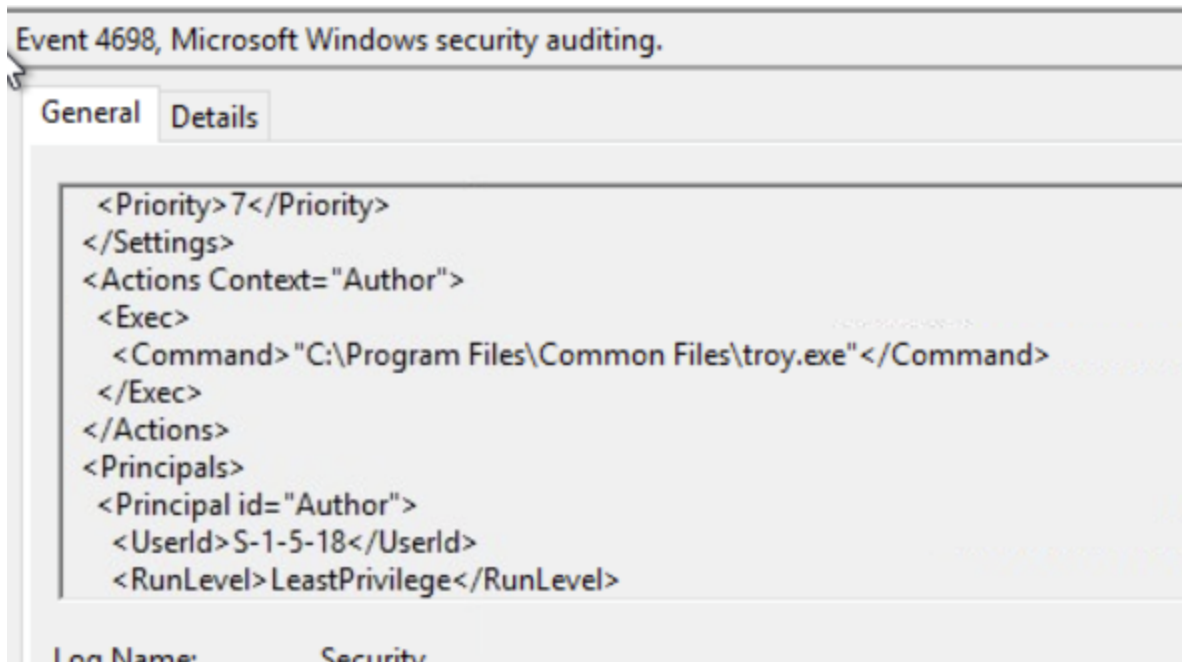
<All Computers>

Clear

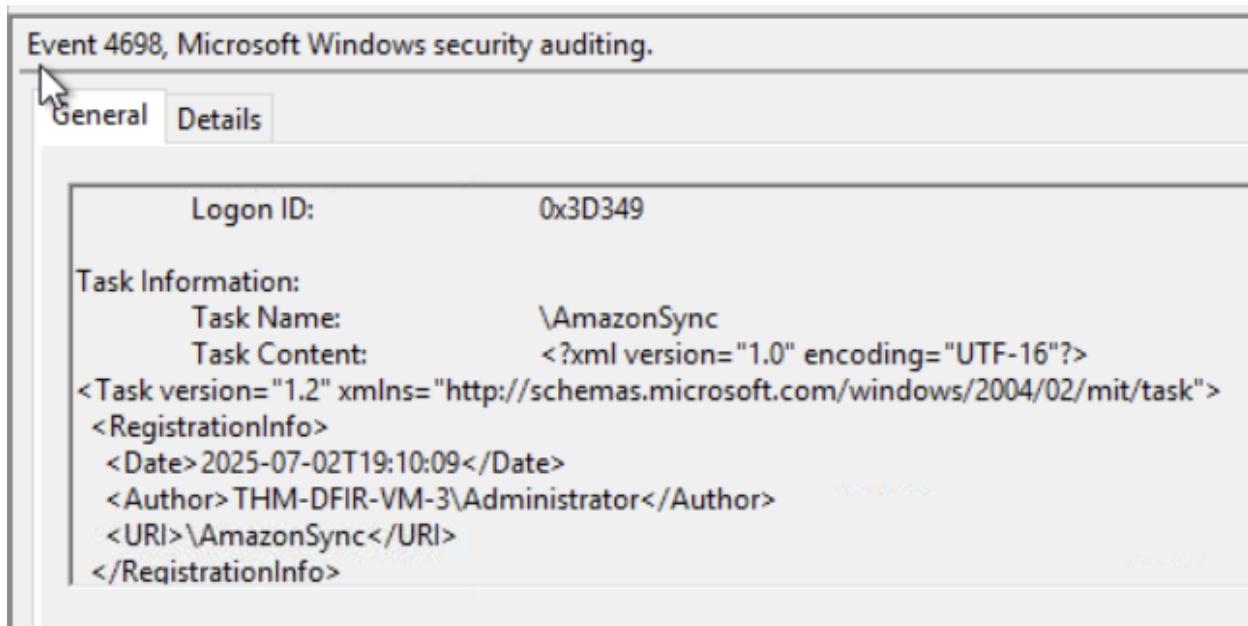
OK

Cancel

We see 5 log files. Starting from the earliest, we find Troy.exe near the bottom of General Information under "Command".



We scroll up to find the task name:



And we find the answer, **AmazonSync**.

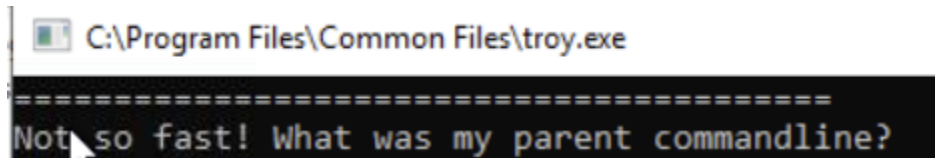
Task 4 Question 3:

What flag do you get after finding and running the Troy malware?

We found out the exact location of the troy.exe file in the preceding question:

```
<Command>"C:\Program Files\Common Files\troy.exe"</Command>
```

When we run it, we are prompted with this question –



We need to backtrack in order to find the parent commandline. From the assignment text --

1. Detect the launch of the `schtasks.exe /create` command via Sysmon event ID **1**

We go back to the Sysmon (After Reboot) log file, and filter down to Sysmon event ID 1:

Filter Current Log

Filter XML

Logged: Any time

Event level: ☐ Critical ☐ Warning ☐ Verbose
☐ Error ☐ Information

☒ By log Event logs: file:///C:/Users/Administrator/Desktop/Practice

☐ By source Event sources:

Includes/Excludes Event IDs: Enter ID numbers and/or ID ranges separated by commas. To exclude criteria, type a minus sign first. For example 1,3,5-99,-76

1

Task category:

Keywords:

User: <All Users>

Computer(s): <All Computers>

Clear

OK Cancel

We sift through the resultant logs to find a mention of the troy.exe image:

Sysmon (After Reboot) Number of events: 97

Filtered: Log: file://C:\Users\Administrator\Desktop\Practice\Task 4\Sysmon

Level	Date and Time
Information	7/4/2025 10:14:07 PM
Information	7/4/2025 10:14:07 PM
Information	7/4/2025 10:14:07 PM
Information	7/4/2025 10:14:07 PM
Information	7/4/2025 10:14:07 PM

Event 1, Sysmon

General Details

UtcTime: 2025-07-04 22:14:05.143
ProcessGuid: {c5d2b969-522d-6868-3400-000000001d01}
ProcessId: 2176
Image: C:\Program Files\Common Files\troy.exe
FileVersion: -
Description: -
Product: -
Company: -
OriginalFileName: -
CommandLine: "C:\Program Files\Common Files\troy.exe" -d
CurrentDirectory: C:\Windows\system32\

We scroll down to find the parent commandline:

ParentCommandLine: C:\Windows\system32\svchost.exe -k netsvcs -p -s Schedule

Then we enter it in cmd:

```
C:\Program Files\Common Files\troy.exe

=====
Not so fast! What was my parent commandline?
Example: C:\Windows\System32\os.exe -run
=====
Your answer: C:\Windows\system32\svchost.exe -k netsvcs -p -s Schedule
THM{c2_is_on_schedule!}
=====
Press Enter to exit..._
```

We find our flag, which is “**THM{c2_is_on_schedule!}**”.

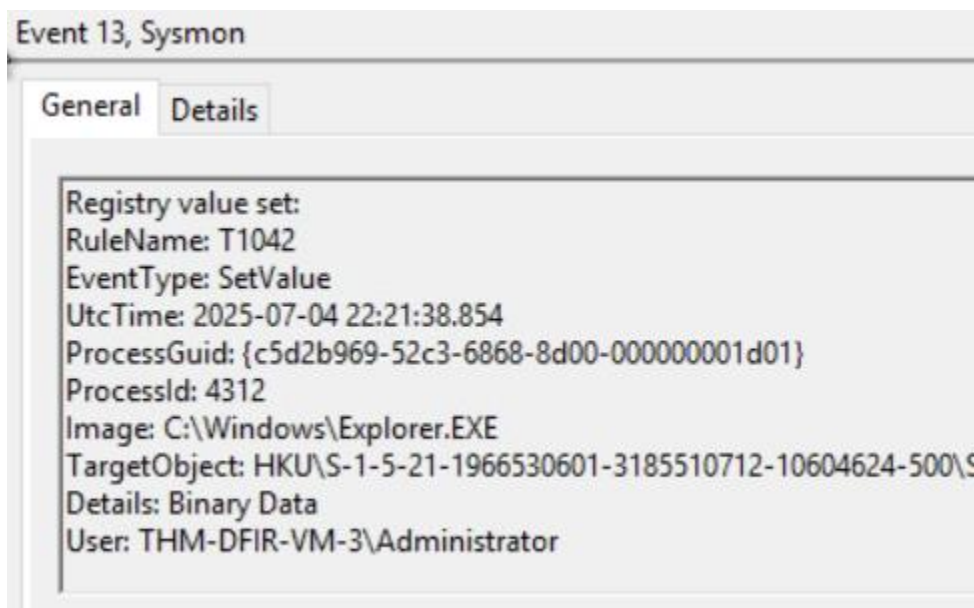
Task 5 Question 1:

To solve this question, I went to the post-reboot log file and found the first eventID 13.

From the text:

To view the "Run" entries, you can launch the `regedit.exe` or search for "Registry Editor" and go to the path shown above. To detect the malicious entry from logs, you can monitor registry change events (Sysmon Event ID **13**) affecting the Run keys:

In the log file:

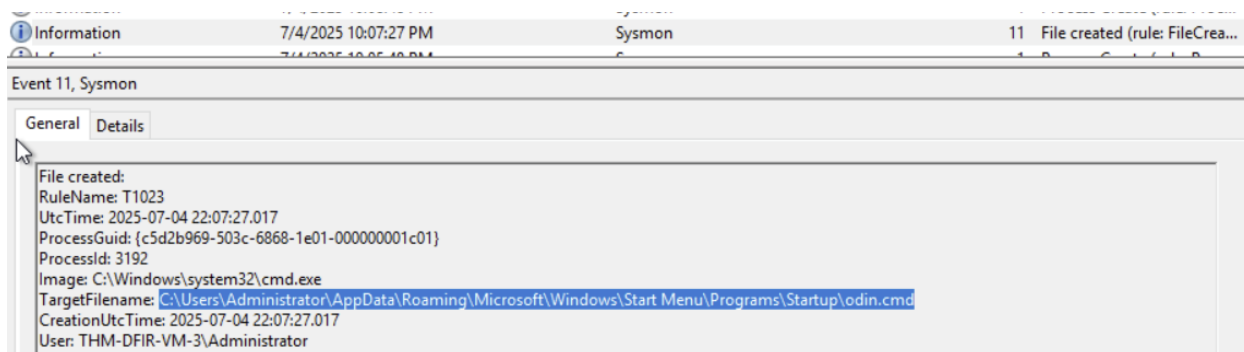


The image listed fit into the box for the answer: **Explorer.exe**

Task 5 Question 2:

What is the last line that the "Odin" malware outputs?

First we search for EventID 11 and scan for Odin in the TargetFilename being created, so we know where to locate it.



We run C:\Users\Administrator\AppData\Roaming\Microsoft\Windows\Start Menu\Programs\Startup\odin.cmd in cmd and the last line reads the answer:

Done Doing Bad Stuff!

Task 5 Question 3:

What flag do you get after finding and running the "Kitten" malware?

We search EventID 13 to find the file location for the Kitten malware.

Sysmon (Before Reboot) Number of events: 16				
Level	Date and Time	Source	Event ID	Task Category
Information	7/4/2025 10:09:47 PM	Sysmon	13	Registry value set (rule: R...
Information	7/4/2025 10:09:44 PM	Sysmon	1	Process Create (rule: Proc...
Information	7/4/2025 10:09:20 PM	Sysmon	13	Registry value set (rule: R...
Information	7/4/2025 10:09:20 PM	Sysmon	13	Registry value set (rule: R...
Information	7/4/2025 10:09:16 PM	Sysmon	22	Dns query (rule: DnsQuery)
Information	7/4/2025 10:09:16 PM	Sysmon	22	Dns query (rule: DnsQuery)

Event 13, Sysmon				
General Details				
Registry value set: RuleName: T1060,RunKey EventType: SetValue UtcTime: 2025-07-04 22:09:47.409 ProcessGuid: {c5d2b969-5128-6868-3501-000000001c01} ProcessId: 5200 Image: C:\Windows\system32\reg.exe TargetObject: HKU\S-1-5-21-1966530601-3185510712-10604624-500\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run\Basket Details: C:\Users\Public\kitten.exe User: THM-DFIR-VM-3\Administrator				
Log Name: Microsoft-Windows-Sysmon/Operational Source: Sysmon Logged: 7/4/2025 10:09:47 PM Event ID: 13 Task Category: Registry value set (rule: RegistryEvent) Level: Information Keywords: User: SYSTEM Computer: THM-DFIR-VM-3 OpCode: Info More Information: Event Log Online Help				

When we run C:\Users\Public\kitten.exe, we are prompted with this question:

```
=====
Not so fast! How is my Run key named?
Example: WinUpdate
```

The “Run key” is the TargetObject, Basket. We obtain the flag:

```
=====
Your answer: Basket
THM{persisting_in_basket!}
=====
Press Enter to exit..._
```

Answer: **THM{persisting_in_basket!}**

Task 6 Question 1:

What is the biggest threat to most corporate Windows networks?

In the text we find:

Let's take a closer look at the third point. In most cases, a Windows network means a large [Active Directory](#) that brings its own attacks, detections, and threats - the main one being **ransomware**. Ransomware scares businesses the most. Why? Because it can bring entire companies to a halt, as it did for McLaren hospitals, [affecting 743,000](#)

The answer is “**ransomware**”

Task 6 Question 2:

At which stage is it best to detect and stop the attack (e.g. Exfiltration)?

In the text we find:

breaches begin, how the attackers steal data, and how they remain undetected for years. You are now ready to use the acquired knowledge to detect and stop the attacks before ransomware causes a disastrous [impact](#), preferably right after Initial Access. Here is a quick recap of what you've learned so far (highlighted in yellow):

The answer is “**Initial Access**”